Joseph Li

Sunnyvale, CA | (734) 934-2168 | lijoseph894@gmail.com | LinkedIn | GitHub | Website

SKILLS

Languages: C++, C, Python, Go, SQL, CUDA

Systems & Tools: Linux, QEMU, Docker, Kubernetes, Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, PostgreSQL, Redis

AI & Machine Learning: PyTorch, LoRA, GRPO, Quantization, Mixture-of-Experts, vLLM, LLM Evaluation, Observability, Langfuse, Operating Systems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CORTEX AI **Menlo Park, CA**

AI Engineer Intern ***Jun. 2026 - Aug. 2026***

- Designed and launched an LLM API gateway in **Go**, **PostgreSQL**, and **Redis** that routes OpenAI, Anthropic, and **AWS Bedrock** through one endpoint for a 2,000-seat customer and meters $10K in monthly model spend
- Built a pre-release test suite with **GitHub Actions**, expanding coverage from 5 smoke tests to 159 tasks so tool regressions were caught before release
- Established live monitoring in **Langfuse**, adopted by all 9 engineers, tracking per-session latency and failures and routing each failure to the engineer responsible
- Reduced wasted model spend by stopping runaway agent loops and using an **LLM judge** to flag unnecessary tool calls

YOYO MARKETS INC. **New York, NY (Remote)**

AI Engineer ***Aug. 2025 - Dec. 2025***

- Automated manual research and editorial work with a **Python** and LLM generation pipeline, producing **50+ markets per week at 5x the hand-curated rate**
- Developed an **asynchronous Python** scraper tracking 150+ high-signal Twitter accounts in real time, feeding that pipeline **3x the signal volume** of public trend aggregators
- Devised a ranking step that uses pairwise LLM comparisons and Elo ratings to screen 200+ candidate markets per cycle and send the strongest to founder review
- Shipped a **Next.js** review dashboard on **Vercel** that founders use daily, cutting **publishing turnaround from 30 minutes to under 5 minutes**

RESEARCH AND PROJECTS

EFFICIENT LLMS | *PyTorch, CUDA, LoRA* **Jan. 2026 - May 2026 | USC**

- Converted **Llama 3.2-1B** into a **Mixture-of-Experts** model with **LoRA** adapters and kept held-out quality level with the original, perplexity **9.60 versus 9.66**
- Quantized weights from **FP16** to **INT4**, cutting model size **61%** while keeping generated answers coherent

MATH REASONING FINE-TUNE | *Python, LoRA* **Aug. 2025 - Dec. 2025 | USC**

- Trained **Qwen2.5-1.5B** with **LoRA** on 1,000 grade-school math problems to write its reasoning before the answer
- Rebuilt the grader until a correct final answer **scored consistently**, then implemented a **GRPO** trainer that rewards a correct, clearly reasoned solution among 4 candidates

WEENIX (A UNIX-LIKE OS KERNEL) | *C, x86, QEMU* **Aug. 2025 - Dec. 2025 | USC**

- Constructed a Unix-like kernel in **C**, with process scheduling, a file system, and virtual memory
- Integrated the three parts in **QEMU** so processes could be scheduled, files created and removed, and a copied process shared memory until one side wrote to it

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA **Los Angeles, CA**

M.S. Computer Science | GPA: 3.6/4.0 *Sep. 2024 - May 2026*

Relevant Coursework: ML Accelerators, Operating Systems

UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN, ANN ARBOR **Ann Arbor, MI**

B.S.E. Data Science | GPA: 3.7/4.0 *Sep. 2020 - May 2024*